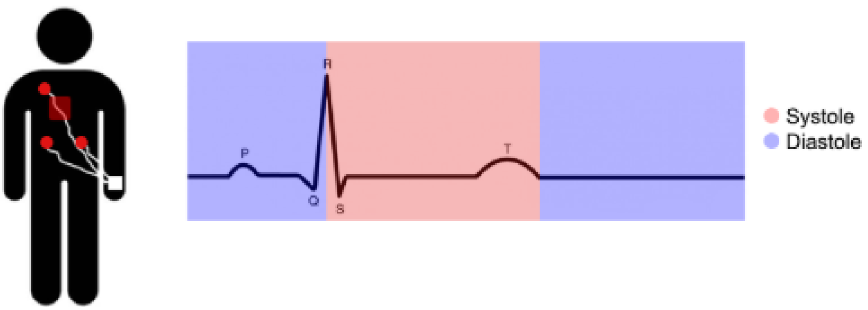
Debriefing

The purpose of this study was for us to understand how humans perceive visual illusions, and whether this relates to physiological (bodily) signals. We are testing the hypothesis that there will be differences in the perceived strength of visual illusions depending on which cardiac phase the perceiver is in when they view the illusion.

The cardiac cycle can be divided into two phases:

- Systole: Where the ventricles of the heart contract, ejecting blood into the arteries, with blood pressure peaking.
- Diastole: Where the ventricles refill with blood, representing a period of relaxation and minimal blood pressure.



ECG signal depicting one cardiac cycle.

Through the **Illusion Game** task, we predict that visual illusion sensitivity will be stronger (i.e., perception will be less accurate) during systole than diastole. This prediction aligns with previous research findings suggestive of reduced perceptual and cognitive abilities during systole (relative to diastole).

We are also assessing the role of **interoception** in this process. Interoception refers to the awareness of internal bodily states - both physiological (e.g., heart rate) and emotional - and it plays a crucial role in how we perceive and interpret the world around us.

Thank you again! Your participation in this study will be kept completely confidential. If you have any questions or concerns about the study, feel free to contact us:

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